



Device hardening

Essential steps for unbreakable mobile defence

Device hardening hinges on a layered approach: timely OS patch management, a verified secure-boot chain, enforced full-disk encryption, and the disabling of unnecessary services and features across mobile and desktop platforms. By following clear, platform-specific steps for Android, iOS, Windows, and macOS, readers will learn how to automate updates, configure hardware-rooted trust mechanisms, and lock down system settings such as developer options and network interfaces.

Advanced measures – including certificate pinning, firewall tuning, and application sandbox enforcement – further strengthen this foundation against modern threats. This chapter equips you to implement an OS-centric defense-in-depth posture, forming the cornerstone of your overall mobile-security strategy.

Automated OS updates and patch management

Keeping your operating system and firmware up to date is the single most effective defense against known vulnerabilities. Unpatched systems are the primary vector for exploits, as attackers continually reverse-engineer public patches to target unpatched devices.

Android: Enabling automatic security patches

1. Verify Android version support

- Choose devices from manufacturers with rapid update cadences – Google Pixel or Android One devices receive monthly security updates directly from Google.